withdrew from Afghanistan and was received by Lord Ellenborough at Ferozepur on 19 December 1842.

Lord Auckland (1784–1899): George Eden, Lord Auckland, was a clever but complacent Whig nobleman. A confirmed bachelor of fifty-one, on arrival in Calcutta he knew little about Indian history or civilisation, and did little to illuminate himself about either. He knew still less about Afghanistan, and in 1838 allowed himself to be manoeuvred by his hawkish advisers into launching an entirely unnecessary invasion to replace Amir Dost Mohammad with Shah Shuja. Unwilling to commit the necessary resources to the unpopular occupation, he was wholly unprepared for the British defeats which followed. The complete destruction of the Kabul army, as Emily Eden noted, aged 'poor George' ten years in as many hours, and he seems to have suffered some kind of stroke. After his replacement by Lord Ellenborough, Auckland lived on in semi-disgrace in Kensington, and died aged only sixty-five in 1849.

Lord Ellenborough (1790–1871): The son of Warren Hastings's defence lawyer, he was a brilliant but difficult and unappealing man, whose physical appearance was so distasteful that George IV was alleged to have claimed that the very sight of Ellenborough made him sick. Ellenborough made his career out of Russophobia and was in many ways the father of the Great Game, that contest of Anglo-Russian imperial competition, espionage and conquest that engaged Britain and Russia until the collapse of their respective Asian empires. In October 1841, he was appointed Governor General to succeed Lord Auckland and arrived in India in time to take credit for the success of the Army of Retribution which allowed the British to withdraw from Afghanistan with some of their military reputation intact. He was 'flighty and unmanageable in all matters of business', wrote one observer, but 'violently enthusiastic on all military matters, and they alone seem to occupy his interests or his attention'.

OTHERS

Count Vasily Alekseevich Perovsky (1794–1857): Governor of the Russian steppe frontier garrison at Orenburg and the Russian counterpart of Claude Wade, Perovsky determined to match British intelligence operations